

User Manual

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1. Getting Started

User asks

How do I install PocketBudJet and finish first-run setup?

What you'll see

Splash, feature showcase, Terms and Disclaimer tabs, optional app lock, then Home. A short wayfinding tour highlights the tab bar, header, drawer, Toolbox, and quick-add button. A 9-step setup wizard is available from Settings when you want guided budget setup.

What to do

1. Install from Google Play (iOS coming soon), then open PocketBudJet and wait through the splash.
2. Swipe the feature showcase and tap Get Started.
3. On first launch, scroll Terms of Service and Disclaimer to the bottom, then tap I Accept — Continue.
4. On Secure Your Data, turn on app lock if you want PIN or biometrics, then continue to Home.
5. Complete the wayfinding landmarks (tab bar, search/Coach header, drawer, Toolbox, quick-add).
6. Optional: open Settings → setup wizard. Enter name, currency, accounts, gross and take-home pay, bills, goals, budgeting style, and accessibility preferences.
7. Want paycheck deductions itemized later? Tap any income transaction and choose Paycheck Breakdown.
8. Enjoy a 15-day free trial with full app access — no credit card required.

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2. Dashboard Overview

User asks

What is Home for, and what should I look at first?

What you'll see

Income, Spent, and Net cards; spending pace; available-to-spend; widgets you can rearrange; and alerts when spending looks unusual.

What to do

1. Land on Home after setup — check Income, Spent, and Net at the top.
2. Use spending pace and available-to-spend to guide today's decisions.
3. Rearrange widgets so the cards you care about sit first.
4. Tap the gold plus (or Activity) when you need to log a transaction quickly.

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3. Adding Transactions

User asks

How do I log spending or income by hand?

What you'll see

Quick-add from any screen, or Activity with Scan / Import / Add. Manual entry covers amount, merchant, category, optional split, notes, and attachments.

What to do

1. Open Activity, or tap the gold plus from any screen.
2. Choose Enter Manually (or Scan / Voice when that fits).

3. Enter the amount first while it is fresh.
4. Type the merchant the same way each time, then pick a category.
5. For multi-category receipts, tap Split and assign portions.
6. Tap Save — budget, account balance, and dashboard update immediately.

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4. Importing Data

User asks

How do I bring in bank history without giving PocketBudJet my bank login?

What you'll see

Import Center / Toolbox entry points, file pickers, review drafts, duplicate handling, and Import History of past files.

What to do

1. Fastest path: in your bank app, open the statement and share it into PocketBudJet (no Downloads folder needed).
2. Or open Toolbox → Import Center and pick CSV, OFX/QFX/QIF/XLSX, PDF statement, screenshot, or email receipt.
3. Review the draft, resolve duplicates, then confirm the import.
4. Open Import History anytime to re-open drafts or audit what changed.

Also available: notification capture from banking apps; multi-month imports for pattern comparison. No bank login or credentials required for file import.

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5. Scanning Documents

PocketBudJet features industry-leading document scanning. Transform paper receipts and bills into organized transactions.

- Receipt scanning with item-level OCR — extract every purchase detail
- Bill and pay stub scanning for income documentation
- WiFi network scanner (eSCL) with ADF support — scan entire multi-page bank statements from your home printer in one tap
- No competitor offers home printer scanning at this scale
- Automatic categorization of scanned items
- Handwriting recognition for handwritten notes on receipts
- Universal document scanner for any financial paperwork

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6. Budget Management

User asks

How do I set category limits and pick a budgeting style?

What you'll see

Budget tab with envelopes/categories, templates (50/30/20, Zero-Based, Aggressive Saver, Envelope, Freelancer), rollover options, and health overlays.

What to do

1. Open the Budget tab from the bottom bar.
2. Create or edit categories and set spending limits.
3. Pick a template or keep a custom layout.
4. Turn on rollover if unused funds should carry forward; copy last month when you want a fast start.
5. Use Budget Health Overlay and variance reports to see where you are over or under.

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7. Bills & Recurring Transactions

User asks

How do I track bills and recurring charges so payday stays calm?

What you'll see

Bills calendar with payday markers, recurring income/expense schedules, subscription list with price-change alerts, and a short-term cash-flow forecast.

What to do

1. Open Bills from the drawer or Plan tab.
2. Add each bill with name, amount, and due day.
3. Mark subscriptions and watch for price-change alerts; use cancellation links when you want out.
4. Check the upcoming-bills overview and the next 30/90-day recurring forecast before big purchases.

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8. Savings & Goals

User asks

How do I track savings goals and sinking funds?

What you'll see

Goals tab with progress bars, sinking funds for irregular expenses, wishlist items with cooling-off, and what-if scenarios.

What to do

1. Open Goals and add a savings target with amount and date.
2. Create sinking funds for car repairs, holidays, or other irregular costs.
3. Add wishlist purchases and use the cooling-off period before you buy.
4. Run a what-if when you want to compare savings strategies.

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9. Debt Management

User asks

How do I plan payoff with avalanche or snowball?

What you'll see

Debt planner with balances, APR, minimums, strategy comparison, payoff date, and interest saved.

What to do

1. Open Debt from Goals or the drawer.
2. Enter balances, APR, and minimum payments for each debt.
3. Choose avalanche (highest interest first) or snowball (smallest balance first).
4. Review debt-free date and interest saved; try what-if extra payments when you can.

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10. Investments & Net Worth

Comprehensive investment and net worth tracking in one app. Monitor stocks, crypto, real estate, and credit score.

- Investment portfolio tracking — stocks, ETFs, mutual funds, bonds via Yahoo Finance

- Crypto tracking with 19 coins: Bitcoin, Ethereum, Solana, Cardano, Dogecoin, and more via CoinGecko
- Property and real estate tracking with Zillow search integration
- Credit score monitoring from 6 different sources
- Net worth tracker with monthly snapshots and trend analysis
- Asset allocation visualization
- Insurance policy tracker with renewal alerts

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11. Reports & Analytics

Deep dive into your spending and financial health with 10+ powerful report types and anomaly detection.

- Budget Health Report — see where money goes vs. budget
- Financial Health Score — comprehensive wellness overview
- Projected Balance Report — forecast future cash position
- Spending Forecast Report — predict upcoming expenses
- Anomaly Dashboard — identify unusual transactions and patterns
- Year over Year Report — compare spending trends
- Tax Return Report — organize deductible expenses
- Annual Budget Report — yearly spending summary
- Net Worth History Report — track asset growth
- Merchant Analysis Report — identify spending by vendor
- Custom reports — build your own with flexible filters
- Automated spending anomaly alerts

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12. AI Financial Coach

User asks

What does Coach do after I log enough real spending?

What you'll see

Coach insights, weekly recap, spending patterns, anomalies, and suggestions based on the data already on your device.

What to do

1. Log transactions consistently so Coach has enough signal to work with.
2. Open Coach from the header or Home to review the latest recap and alerts.
3. Use the suggestions to adjust budgets, spot unusual spending, and track goal progress.
4. Keep it opt-in only where available; you stay in control of what is analyzed.

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13. AI Assistant

User asks

How do I ask PocketBudJet questions instead of digging through menus?

What you'll see

An assistant entry point from any screen, example prompts, and answer cards for totals, trends, merchants, categories, budgets, and date ranges.

What to do

1. Open the AI Assistant button from any screen.
2. Ask a direct question such as “How much did I spend on groceries last month?”
3. Use natural dates like “last week,” “this quarter,” or “January.”

4. Review the returned amounts, charts, and lists, then refine the question if you need a narrower date range or merchant.

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14. Search

User asks

How do I find a past transaction fast?

What you'll see

Universal search for merchants, amounts, dates, categories, and fuzzy matches for near-miss spellings.

What to do

1. Open Universal Search from the header.
2. Start with plain terms like “coffee last week” or “over \$50”.
3. Add category, merchant, tag, or date words if you need to narrow the result list.
4. Save filters you reuse often.

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15. Export & Sharing

User asks

How do I get my data out for Excel, an accountant, or another device?

What you'll see

Export formats including CSV, JSON, PDF, Word, Excel, OFX, and HTML; sharing tools for date ranges and accountant-ready reports.

What to do

1. Open Export from Toolbox or the export area in Settings.
2. Choose the target format that matches the next step: spreadsheet, report, archive, or sharing link.
3. Limit the export to the needed date range when you do not want to share everything.
4. Use encrypted export when the file contains sensitive data.

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16. PC Web Dashboard

User asks

How do I use PocketBudJet on a computer on my home network?

What you'll see

Web Companion / PC Dashboard with a local address and pairing path (QR or typed URL).
Browser tabs for Dashboard, Transactions, Budget, Debt, and Reports.

What to do

1. On your phone, open Toolbox (or Settings → Export) and start PC Web Companion / PC Dashboard.
2. On your PC browser, open the shown URL or scan the QR code while both devices share the same Wi-Fi.
3. Use the five tabs to review and edit — changes sync with the phone in real time.
4. Stop the session from the phone when you are done; sessions time out after inactivity.

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17. Tax Features

User asks

How do I keep deductible spending organized before tax time?

What you'll see

Deductible category tags, summaries, comparison reports, quarterly estimate tools, and self-employed tracking.

What to do

1. Tag deductible transactions as you log or review them.
2. Open tax summaries to check totals by category before filing season.
3. Use the quarterly estimate and mileage tools if you have business expenses.
4. Export an accountant-ready report when it is time to share records.

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18. Household Sync

User asks

How do two phones stay in sync without handing everything to a cloud account?

What you'll see

Pairing between devices, shared household views, and conflict handling when both people edit near the same time.

What to do

1. Open Household Sync on the first device and start pairing.
2. Use the shown QR or pairing path on the second device while both are nearby or on the same network.
3. Choose the shared or separate view style that fits your household.
4. After pairing, review the shared dashboard and recent transactions to confirm both sides are aligned.

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19. Calendar View

User asks

How do I see bills, income, and spending by date instead of by list?

What you'll see

A monthly calendar with transaction dots, bill due dates, payday markers, and color-coded activity.

What to do

1. Open the calendar from Bills / Plan.
2. Swipe between months to look ahead or review what already happened.
3. Tap any day to open its transactions and due items.
4. Use the payday markers and recurring indicators to spot tight weeks before they become stressful.

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20. Transaction Bookmarks & Rules

User asks

How do I stop repeating the same categorization work?

What you'll see

Bookmarks for frequent entries, auto-rules for merchant patterns, and bulk-edit tools when a whole batch needs the same fix.

What to do

1. Bookmark common transactions you enter often.
2. Create a rule when the same merchant or pattern keeps landing in the same category.
3. Use bulk edit to fix groups of imported transactions at once.

4. Rename labels centrally when employers, payees, or categories change.

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21. Accessibility

User asks

How do I make PocketBudJet easier to read and operate?

What you'll see

Dark mode, contrast options, colorblind-friendly charts, large text, screen-reader support, and font scaling.

What to do

1. Open Settings and start with display preferences like dark mode and contrast.
2. Turn on the colorblind-friendly palette if chart colors are hard to distinguish.
3. Increase text size or rely on system font scaling for better readability.
4. Combine these with App lock if shared-device privacy matters too.

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22. Mindful Features

User asks

How do I slow impulse spending down without making the app annoying?

What you'll see

Mindful Budget View, time-cost framing, pause prompts, cooling-off periods, and milestone encouragement.

What to do

1. Open Mindful Features in Settings.
2. Turn on the pause and cooling-off options you want before big purchases.
3. Use Time Cost Mode when you want purchases expressed as hours of work.
4. Let the milestone badges and reflection prompts reinforce good decisions without changing your core budget data.

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23. Retirement Planning

User asks

How do I turn long-range retirement goals into something I can actually track?

What you'll see

Retirement milestones, target age and income inputs, savings progress, and projection tools.

What to do

1. Open Retirement Planning from the Toolbox.
2. Enter your target retirement age, desired income, and current savings.
3. Review milestone progress and projection outputs.
4. Adjust savings goals when the numbers or your timeline change.

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24. Voice Shortcuts

User asks

Can I log or check things hands-free?

What you'll see

Built-in Siri or Google Assistant shortcuts for logging spending, checking budgets, and querying current totals.

What to do

1. Enable the built-in shortcuts you want first.
2. Use simple commands like “I spent \$20 on coffee” or ask for current budget status.
3. Test one or two common actions until they feel natural.
4. Create custom shortcuts for the actions you repeat most.

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25. Pricing

User asks

What trial and plan options does PocketBudJet offer?

What you'll see

A 15-day free trial plus monthly, annual, and 3-year paid options.

What to do

1. Start with the 15-day free trial if you want full access without a card first.
 2. Compare monthly, annual, and 3-year plans based on how long you expect to keep using the app.
 3. Choose annual or 3-year if lower effective monthly cost matters more than flexibility.
 4. Cancel during the free trial if you decide it is not for you.
- 15-Day free trial — full app access, no credit card needed
 - Monthly: \$9.99/month with auto-renew
 - Annual: \$74.99/year (37% off monthly rate)
 - 3-Year: \$149.99/three years (58% off monthly rate, no auto-renew)
 - All plans include full feature access

- Money-back guarantee within 30 days

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26. Privacy & Security

User asks

Where does my data live, and how do I lock the app?

What you'll see

Privacy and Backup settings, optional encrypted cloud backup, app lock controls, and a one-time recovery key.

What to do

1. Keep core data on-device — no bank login and no cloud required for day-to-day use.
2. Optional: in Privacy and Backup, turn on encrypted cloud backup and set retention.
3. Enable Face ID, Touch ID, or a passcode under App lock.
4. When you enable a lock, save the recovery key offline (shown once). Rotate it later from Settings → Security → Recovery Key if needed.
5. Locked out? Enter the recovery key to reset the lock — data stays put; no reinstall.

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27. Data & Storage Management

User asks

How do I keep storage under control without losing my financial history?

What you'll see

Backup retention, on-device working-set controls, receipt-image storage, annual summaries, free-space preview, and archive-history status under Settings → Data & Backup.

What to do

1. Choose a backup-retention window that matches how much detailed history you need readily available.
2. Set the on-device working set based on how much offline history you want on the phone.
3. Tune receipt-image preview storage separately from full backup retention.
4. Use Review & Free Up Space before removing anything, and confirm archive status before assuming older years are fully stored.

Backup Retention

- Choose how far back your backup keeps full transaction details: 6 months up to 7 years
- Data that ages out is summarized — annual totals, top categories, and net savings are locked permanently
- Summaries are yours forever regardless of which retention window you choose

On-Device Working Set

- Controls how many months of transactions live on your phone for instant offline access
- Minimum 3 months — the floor PocketBudJet needs to reliably track budget patterns
- Extend up to 2 years if you want more history available without fetching from backup

Receipt Image Storage

- Three-tier model: thumbnails always stay on device, full images live in backup, compressed previews are tiered
- Choose your preview window: 30, 60, 90, or 180 days on-device before moving to backup-only
- Tap any receipt to fetch the full image from backup whenever you need it

Annual Summaries

- Year-by-year totals computed and locked permanently before any data ages out
- Income, expenses, and net savings for every year you've used the app — never deleted
- Power your all-time analysis even after underlying transactions have been archived

Free Up Space

- Tap 'Review & Free Up Space' to preview exactly what would be removed before anything happens
- Preview shows transaction count, receipt image impact, and estimated space reclaimed
- Annual summaries are always computed and backup-confirmed before any data leaves the device

Archive History

- Track the status of every archived year: transaction count, backup confirmation, and completion date
- Years show as 'Pending' until backup confirms receipt — data stays on device until confirmed
- Full audit trail so you always know what has been safely stored

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Website: jospatech.com/how-to

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